

MoneyLingo Lesson Template & Example

1. MoneyLingo Master Template

Hook

Write a 2–4 line opening that creates curiosity using a real-life scenario. End with tension or a question. Do NOT define the term.

Core Lesson

Provide a one-sentence definition followed by 3–5 bullet points explaining how it works in real life in plain language.

Aha Moment

Use real numbers. Include: dollar amount, time frame, two scenarios, monthly payment, total paid, and exact dollar difference. End with a strong punchline.

Word Wallet

List 3–5 terms. For each: definition + 'Here's how it works:' explaining real-life impact.

Quiz

Write 5 multiple-choice questions (A–D) with one correct answer each. Test understanding.

Simulation

Provide a simulation tool, where appropriate, and a prompt that tells the user how to use the simulation.

Where a simulation tool is not appropriate, create a realistic scenario with 2–3 choices showing different behaviors and implied consequences.

IRL (In Real Life)

Provide exactly 3 actionable steps. Each includes a short description, link if relevant, and ends with: 'Go now | Save this in my Financial Moves'.

2. Example Lesson: Credit Scores

Hook

You finally save up for a car. You're ready.

But when you apply for the loan... you get hit with a payment that feels way too high.

Same car. Same price.
So why are you paying so much more?

Core Lesson

A credit score is a number (300–850) that tells lenders how likely you are to repay money.

- Payment history matters most
- Credit usage impacts your score
- Length of credit history matters
- New credit applications affect your score

Higher scores = lower borrowing costs.

Aha Moment

Let's break it down with real numbers on a **\$15,000 car loan over 5 years**:

- Person A (Credit Score: 750) → **5% interest**
Monthly payment: **\$283**
Total paid: **\$16,980**
- Person B (Credit Score: 600) → **15% interest**
Monthly payment: **\$357**
Total paid: **\$21,420**

Same car. Same \$15,000.

But Person B pays **\$4,440 more**.

That's nearly **30% extra**—for nothing different except their credit score.

That's the Aha:

Your credit score isn't just a number—
It's how much extra you pay for the same life.

Word Wallet

Credit Score: A number showing creditworthiness
Here's how it works: Higher scores mean better loan terms.

Interest Rate: Cost of borrowing money
Here's how it works: Higher rates = more total paid.

Credit Report: Record of financial behavior

Here's how it works: Lenders use it to judge you.

Utilization: % of credit used

Here's how it works: Staying under 30% helps your score.

Quiz

Which increases your credit score?

- A. Missing payments
- B. Maxing out credit
- C. Paying on time
- D. Opening many accounts

Answer: C

Simulation

You get your first credit card with a \$500 limit.

What do you do?

- A. Spend \$450 and make minimum payments
- B. Spend \$150 and pay it off in full every month
- C. Max it out and miss a payment

Watch how your credit score changes based on your habits—and how fast small decisions add up.

IRL (In Real Life)

1. Check your credit report for free

See exactly what lenders see about you.

👉 <https://www.annualcreditreport.com>

Go now | Save this in my Financial Moves

2. Set up autopay for one bill

Build a perfect payment history without thinking about it.

Go now | Save this in my Financial Moves

3. Keep your credit usage under 30%

If your limit is \$500, stay under \$150 to help boost your score.

Go now | Save this in my Financial Moves

